Harry's account audit: 30 October 2026

All data was pulled live from Upwork today: your profile, your dashboard, 15 client searches (about 100 result pages) and 12 new editors who got orders in September–October 2026. No search result was a paid (boosted) placement.

Short answer

- **Your profile text is now as good as the editors who get hired.** Your title, overview, skills and keyword line match or beat theirs.
- **You are invisible in search.** You appear in only 1 of 15 searches: **#87** among Nigerian newcomers. You're not in the top 225 for any normal client search.
- **The reason is proof, not words.** You have **0 video portfolio items, 0 video jobs and 0 video proposals.** All 12 new editors who got orders this month have video portfolio items and video jobs.
- **Your 28 portfolio items are all web development, AI automation or Roblox.** Upwork reads them and still sends you AI automation and GoHighLevel jobs, not video jobs.
- **The fix:** add 6–10 video portfolio items, remove the old ones, and send 2–4 proposals a day for small $10–$30 single-clip jobs. One small paid job is likely to move you into search more than any further text change.

1. Your account today

Item	Status	Verdict
Title	Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok & YouTube Shorts | Podcasts	✅ Good
Overview	~2,500 characters: hook, services, packages, tools, free sample, keyword line	✅ Good
Skills	20 video skills	✅ Good
Rate	$10/hr (changed from $18)	✅ Matches new editors (median $10)
Portfolio	28 items, **0 video**: web/SaaS, Claude automation, Roblox	❌ Biggest problem
Work history	0 jobs, 0 reviews	❌ Needs first jobs
Proposals	2 sent ever (Roblox and AI automation), neither viewed; **0 video proposals**	❌ Start applying
Employment	None (Roblox entries deleted)	⚠️ Add 1 honest video entry
Other experience	Being added by you (3 video entries)	✅ Once added
Education	University of Lagos	✅ Fine

Item	Status	Verdict
Video intro	None	⚠️ +10 free Connects when added
Consultation	Off	⚠️ Turn on
Connects	80	✅ Enough for about 8–16 proposals
ID verified	Yes	✅
Jobs Upwork suggests to you	Mostly AI automation and GoHighLevel, plus a few AI video jobs	❌ Upwork still sees you as an automation freelancer
Invitation	"Academic Facilitator – Degree Program Student Support in Nigeria" (Enterprise client)	Not video. Decline or accept as you choose

2. How far you've come

	20 October (Roblox profile)	30 October (now)
Niche	Roblox developer, mixed with AI automation	Short-form video editor only
Title	Roblox UI/UX + Luau scripter	Exact client search words: short-form, Reels, TikTok, Shorts, podcasts
Overview	Roblox, with an automation section	Video only, with packages, free sample and keyword line
Skills	15 Roblox + 5 automation	20 video skills
Employment	20 Roblox entries	Cleaned
Education	3 entries, 2 of them Roblox courses	University only
Best search position	#145–148 (Roblox scripter searches)	#87 (Nigeria newcomers, short-form)

Your profile text is now finished. The remaining gaps are portfolio, proposals and first jobs.

3. Where you rank (30 October)

#	Client search	Your position
1	short form video editor	Not in top 225
2	TikTok video editor	Not in top 225
3	Reels editor	Not in top 225
4	YouTube Shorts editor	Not in top 225
5	podcast clips editor	Not in top 225
6	CapCut editor	Not in top 225
7	video editor	Not in top 225

#	Client search	Your position
8	Skills: Short Video + Instagram Reels	Not in top 225
9	short form video editor (Nigeria)	Not in top 125
10	TikTok editor (Nigeria)	Not in top 125
11	Reels editor (Nigeria)	Not in top 125
12	podcast clips editor (Nigeria)	Not in top 125
13	short form video editor (newcomers only)	Not in top 125
14	short form video editor (newcomers + Nigeria)	**#87**
15	video editor (Nigeria)	Not in top 125

What decides the order (from the results):

- **Track record comes first.** In normal searches almost every top result has a Job Success Score, earnings, or both, and most are Top Rated.
- **A small amount of earnings is enough to get in.** Profiles with only $100–$700 earned and no score appeared in the top 225 (Hao N. with $100+ at #68, Darxan S. with $300+ at #87). This suggests **one small paid job would help you more than any profile edit** (our reading of the results, not an Upwork rule).
- **Among Nigerian newcomers, the profiles above you mostly:**
  - have **consultation turned on**
  - charge **$3–$8/hr**
  - have "AI", "UGC" or "Ads" in the title
  - name tools like CapCut in the title

  A full skill list isn't what lifts them: Chizorba E. is #3 with only 8 skills.

Your direct competitors (newcomers + Nigeria, top 5): Anuoluwapo O. ($5, consultation on), Barakat O. ($3), Chizorba E. ($10), Opeyemi H. ($5), Serena N. ($8). Samson A. (#7, $5) is in almost exactly your niche.

4. What new editors with orders have that you don't

These are 12 short-form editors without a badge whose video jobs started in September–October 2026: Chioma U., Farida U., Qosim O., Elizabeth P., Oyinkansola R. and Isaac T. (Nigeria), plus Dua D., Areej R., Alexandro P., Mohamed A., Lam P. and Linh D.

What they have	Them	You
Video portfolio items	**12 of 12** (minimum 4, typically ~14)	**0**
Video jobs in work history	**12 of 12**	0

What they have	Them	You
A small fixed-price video job (≤ $20)	9 of 12	0
At least 1 video employment entry	11 of 12	0
Social proof in the overview (numbers, a client quote)	6 of 12	0 (fine until you have real results)
Video intro	5 of 12	No
Consultation offered ($10–$30)	4 of 12	No
A test or trial job shown	3 of 12	No
Where you already match or beat them		
Short-form keywords in the title	12 of 12	✅ Yes
Rate around $10	Median $10	✅ $10
17+ skills	7 of 12	✅ 20
Keyword line in the overview	5 of 12	✅ Yes
Packages or prices in the overview	0 of 12	✅ Yes
Free sample offer	1 of 12	✅ Yes

How they got their first orders. Almost always it was one reel or short edit at a $5–$30 fixed price, finished in 1–3 days with a 5★ review. Within 2–6 weeks, at least 6 of the 12 turned that into bigger work worth $111–$360.

- **Farida U. (Lagos, joined around September):** $143 on 6 October, then $260 on 12 October. Her portfolio includes a "TEST VIDEO FOR CLIENT" item.
- **Dua D. (Pakistan):** a $20 "Test video to see skill set" and two $10 shorts jobs, then hourly work of $156 and $243.
- **Linh D. (Vietnam):** $20 and $12 jobs, then $15 per reel, then $330 from the same client.
- **Areej R. (Pakistan):** a $15 reels job with a 5★ review, then hourly contracts of $185–$360.
- **Alexandro P. (Argentina):** his first 5 portfolio items are photo edits, much like your non-video portfolio. The video items placed after them still won him 5+ repeat jobs at $45–$75.

Don't copy: 75–100 self-entered employment entries (Chioma, Elizabeth, Oyinkansola) or "Top Rated" claims without the badge (Linh). And be careful with many cheap tests: Elizabeth's success score fell to 77 after a client ended a job with a 3★ review.

5. What to fix, in order

This week (most important first):

1. **Portfolio: add 6–10 video items** from your portfolio plan PDF (podcast clip, talking-head reel, before/after first). Use stock footage, your own recordings or edits made with permission, and label practice work "Sample edit".

2. **Portfolio: remove or hide all 28 old items** (web, SaaS, Claude automation, Roblox). They tell Upwork you're an automation developer. If you want to keep 1–2, move them to the end.
3. **Send 2–4 video proposals a day.** Look for jobs under 24 hours old with fewer than 10 proposals and payment verified, especially single-clip jobs, "test video" jobs and podcast clip jobs at $10–$30 fixed. Today's matches included "NBA 2K Gameplay Editor for YouTube Shorts" (under 5 proposals) and "GTA 6 Live Stream Clipper/Editor" (under 5 proposals, entry level).
4. **Turn on a consultation:** "30-min Short-Form Content Review" for $10–$15. Most Nigerian newcomers ranked above you offer one.
5. **Add 1 employment entry**, but only if it's true: e.g. Company "Freelance", Job title "Short-Form Video Editor", with your real start date and the real work you've done.

Next 2 weeks: 6. **Record a video intro** (script in the plan PDF). You get +10 Connects, and 5 of 12 new earners have one. 7. **Publish the 3 catalog projects** from the portfolio plan PDF and pause the Roblox ones. 8. **Deliver your first job in 24–48 hours and ask for a review.** Then offer a monthly package.

Keep as is: title, overview, skills and the $10/hr rate. Don't lower it to $3–$5. Win jobs with small fixed prices instead.

After your first 3–5 reviews: add one real result line to the top of your overview (e.g. "Edited 40+ clips for a fitness coach, 5★"). Then raise prices by about 30%.